



Delaware County Commissioner Meeting March 7th 2023

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0ZyTF93OOUg
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Delaware County Commissioners Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: March 7, 2023

Convened Time: 9:09 AM

1. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer opened the regular meeting of the Delaware County Commissioners on Tuesday, March 7, 2023, at 9:09 AM.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Commissioner James King, Commissioner Sherry Reagan, and Commissioner Burke. *(Note: Commissioner Henry was absent due to recent knee surgery and attempted to join via Zoom connection).*
 - **Presiding Officer:** Sherry Reagan (implied by leadership/motion flow).

2. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance.

- **Approval of Minutes:** The minutes from the February 21, 2023 meeting were approved by voice vote following a motion and second.
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3. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:01:17 Appointment: Meridian Mental Health Board**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board / Commissioners
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The board addressed an open seat on the Meridian Mental Health Board. Commissioner Sherry Reagan asked Commissioner James King if he would be willing to serve as the board's representative. Commissioner King accepted.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (Motion: King, Second: Reagan).
- **00:02:14 Contract / Grant: Community Foundation Grant (Emergency Communication Center / 9-1-1)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Kevin Cummings, 9-1-1 Director
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Director Cummings presented a \$25,000 grant for mobile dispatch vehicles and requested the creation of an ordinance and suspension of rules to deposit the physical check. Staff clarified that the fund falls under the Emergency Communication Center (9-1-1), designated as Ordinance 2023-007.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:**
 - Ordinance 2023-007 introduced: Approved by Voice Vote.
 - Rules suspended: Approved by Voice Vote.
 - Ordinance 2023-007 adopted: Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:04:29 Agreement: Local Roads and Bridge Matching Grant Agreement (INDOT)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Angie (County Engineer/Staff)
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Presented a standard INDOT boilerplate contract for a 50% matching grant totaling \$352,339.99. Funding targets road paving projects including Walnut Street, Black Cemetery Road, 550 East, 800 West, and Proctor Road. Bids for the projects recently opened under estimates.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:05:41 Agreement for Consulting Services: Donna Patterson**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Ed / Commissioners
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Due to Donna Patterson's retirement at the end of the month (March 31st), the county requested to retain her on a part-time, as-needed consulting basis at a rate of \$25 per hour (matching the historical textile consultant rate used by the office). Commissioners commended her service.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:06:50 Agreement for Consulting Services: Dosset Consulting**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Auditor's Office / Ed

- **Deliberation Summary:** Approval of the annual recurring consulting contract with Jeff Dosset.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:07:14 Agreement: Government Utilities Technical Service (GUTS) Two-Year Addendum**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Kathy Butterfield, Delaware County Treasurer's Office
 - **Deliberation Summary:** A two-year contract extension with GUTS for annual tax sale tracking software and technical services.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:07:50 Agreement: Schneider GIS (Beacon Web Integration for Past Taxes)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Kathy Butterfield, Delaware County Treasurer's Office
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Butterfield reported a massive increase in phone calls and email inquiries regarding past-due taxes (approx. 3,500 inquiries in the first three months of the year). To reduce staff time spent answering lookup calls, the office proposed partnering with Schneider GIS to put past tax data (going back five years) onto the web/Beacon mapping platform for a one-time setup fee of \$3,528.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:09:24 Grant: Sheriff's Department JAG Grant (Ordinance 2023-009)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Captain Tony Johnson, Delaware County Sheriff's Office
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Captain Johnson presented the annual Edward Byrne Memorial Justice Assistance Grant (JAG), a joint grant with the city used primarily for enhanced patrols and security at the Delaware County Fair. He requested introduction, suspension of rules, and adoption. *(Note: Captain Johnson also provided an informational update on pursuing grants for a new multi-agency up-armored SWAT response vehicle through the Gary Sinise Foundation and State Homeland Security Program).*
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:**
 - Ordinance introduced: Approved by Voice Vote.
 - Rules suspended: Approved by Voice Vote.
 - Ordinance 2023-009 adopted: Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:13:04 Memorandums of Understanding (MOUs): Health Department School Grants**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jamie Bain, Health Department Administrator
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Five MOUs similar to the previous month's Yorktown MOU, establishing terms to disburse grant funding to local school corporations.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** All five MOUs approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:13:59 Ordinance 2023-008: Extension of Solar Farm Moratorium**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commissioners / John (Attorney)

- **Deliberation Summary:** First reading of an ordinance to extend the county's temporary moratorium on solar farms until at least August, allowing the Planning Commission's solar committee time to finalize its work and recommendations. The previous moratorium expired on February 22nd.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:**
 - First reading approved: Voice Vote.
 - Rules suspended: Approved by Voice Vote.
 - Ordinance 2023-008 adopted: Approved by Voice Vote.
 - **00:15:23 Resolution 2023-008: Property Transfer to Non-Profit**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commissioners / Legal
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Initiates the statutory process for a public hearing to transfer an unsold tax-sale certificate property to a qualified non-profit organization.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
 - **00:24:54 Payment of Claims**
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Review and payment of general county claims totaling \$944,655.67, alongside American Rescue Plan (ARP) claims totaling \$7,768.37.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
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4. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:25:37 Ricky Hampshire** (Muncie resident and author)
 - **Key Concerns:**
 1. *Opioid Settlement Funds:* Noted that the city recently allocated opioid settlement funds toward a crisis center, pointing out that Delaware County and Muncie share roughly \$6 million from national settlements. He inquired about the county's strategy and spending plans regarding its share, suggesting local support for groups like Brianna's hope, Recovery Cafe, AA/NA, and "The Norm" (supporting addiction and homelessness).
 2. *Road Infrastructure & Grants:* Addressed widespread public complaints regarding local road conditions. He asked whether the county is actively applying for federal infrastructure funds made available through Congress to help offset local road repair costs.
 - **Commissioner Response:** Commissioner King responded that the county utilizes TIF (Tax Increment Financing) dollars, wheel tax revenues, and Community Crossing matching grants to aggressively fund road paving and bridge repairs.
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5. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff & Departmental Updates:**

- **Kevin Cummings (9-1-1):** Discussed ongoing staffing shortages and proposed creating a salary line item for a **\$5,000 lateral transfer stipend** for certified, experienced dispatchers (paid out in two milestones: half upon passing the internal training program, and the remainder after six months of satisfactory performance). The board directed staff to work with the attorney to draft an ordinance for the March 20th meeting ahead of Council appropriation.
- **Rick Spangler (County Clerk):** Noted that the voting center resolution failed locally, reverting polling station approval responsibilities back to the Commissioners. Submitted the official 2023 polling sites list and requested staff assistance in sending out venue contracts. Approved by Voice Vote.
- **Steve Foster (Building Superintendent):** Provided facilities updates regarding the Justice Center roof repairs, emergency backup power following a recent outage, ongoing auditorium lighting issues, and upcoming budget requests regarding heating maintenance.
- **ARP Administrator (Dave):** Requested an administrative plan amendment/transfer within ARP administrative fees to cover employee salaries for administering ARP funds (transitioning from 1099 structures). Directed to coordinate with legal counsel for the March 20th meeting.
- **Adjournment:** The meeting was moved into recess by unanimous voice vote (00:28:25).